

Scholarship and Financial Aid Guide

Academic Year 2026-2027

Office of Student Financial Services

Awards for 2026-2027

CURRENT

Document ID: NSU-AID-2026

Fictional educational corpus. All names, contacts, programs, and rules are synthetic.

1. Application and General Eligibility

Students seeking need-based Northstar aid submit the federal aid application and Northstar Aid Form by March 1, 2026. Late files are reviewed after on-time applicants and only while funds remain.

Institutional aid normally requires full-time enrollment of at least 12 credits. A student in the final term may request prorated aid for 6 to 11 credits when fewer than 12 credits are needed to graduate.

Aid may be revised when enrollment, housing, residency, outside assistance, or satisfactory academic progress changes.

- Priority aid deadline: March 1, 2026.
- Normal full-time threshold: 12 credits.
- Final-term exception may apply at 6-11 credits.

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2. Merit Scholarship Renewal

The Northstar Achievement Scholarship requires a cumulative institutional GPA of at least 3.25 and completion of at least 24 Northstar credits during the academic year. Transfer credits do not satisfy the annual 24-credit requirement.

Renewal is reviewed after spring grades. A student below one requirement receives a one-year probationary renewal only when the GPA is at least 3.00 and at least 21 Northstar credits were completed.

A student may receive no more than eight full-time semesters of the scholarship. General academic good standing at a 2.00 GPA does not by itself satisfy scholarship renewal.

Status	GPA and credit requirement
Standard renewal	3.25 GPA and 24 Northstar credits
One-year probationary renewal	At least 3.00 GPA and 21 Northstar credits
Maximum duration	8 full-time semesters

Reference: NSU-AID-2026 | CURRENT

3. Experiential Access Award

The Experiential Access Award supports students accepting unpaid or low-paid internships. Applicants must have an approved internship, demonstrate financial need, and submit a budget before the internship begins.

Awards range from \$500 to \$2,500 for transportation, temporary housing, required clothing, or other documented participation costs. Tuition and ordinary semester housing are not eligible.

Receiving the award does not reduce internship-credit hours, registration, reflection, or supervisor-evaluation requirements in the Internship Guidelines.

- Award range: \$500-\$2,500.
- Internship approval is required.
- Academic internship requirements remain unchanged.

Reference: NSU-AID-2026 | CURRENT

4. Satisfactory Progress and Appeals

Financial-aid satisfactory progress requires a cumulative 2.00 GPA, completion of at least 67 percent of attempted credits, and completion within 150 percent of the program's published credits.

A student losing aid may appeal by the deadline in the notice when illness, death in the family, or another extraordinary circumstance affected progress. The appeal explains what changed and includes an academic plan when requested.

Questions go to finaid@northstar.example or 555-2130. Grade disputes must be resolved under the Examination and Grading Policy; Financial Services cannot change grades.

- Minimum completion rate: 67 percent.
- Maximum timeframe: 150 percent.
- Financial Services cannot alter academic grades.

Reference: NSU-AID-2026 | CURRENT